

Divide And Rule!

Q My computer configuration is as follows: 2.40 GHz Intel Celeron processor, 40 GB hard disk and 256 MB RAM. My OS is Windows XP. I also want to run Windows 98 on my computer and this is where the problem arises. I have only two partitions on the hard disk. One (D :) is full of system recovery i.e., of 4 GB while the other (C:) has Windows XP, taking up 36 GB. Here, nearly 10 GB of space is free. I want to make another partition without backing up my data so as to install Windows 98 there. Is there any software that allows a partition out of the free space available on C: while working on it?

Another problem related to installing Windows 98 over XP. Will it replace the boot loader of Windows XP and boot to Windows 98? If yes, what should be done to correct the boot loader so as when I boot up my PC, it will prompt me whether I want go for 98 or XP. I don't want reinstall Windows XP.

Sunil S Kewade
Nagpur

A To create a partition in the free space of your hard drive without losing any data, you will need to use a utility known as Ranish Partition Manager from www.ranish.com or Norton Partition Magic 8 from www.powerquest.com. It is never 100 per cent safe to play with partitions and be assured that your data will not be lost. Still it is advisable to back up your important data before you begin the creation of the partition.

In order to restore the Windows XP boot loader, you need to follow these steps: Create a Win98 Startup Disk. Create a text file with the following entries, exactly as shown:

```
L 100 2 0 1
N C:\BOOTSECT.DOS
R BX
0
R CX
200
W
Q
```

Save the file to the Win98 Startup Disk as READ.SCR. Boot the computer with the Win98 Startup Disk and at the A: prompt, type
DEBUG <READ.SCR

These steps will create the BOOTSECT.DOS file needed to boot Win98. You may need to use the ATTRIB C:\BOOTSECT.DOS -S -H -R command if BOOTSECT.DOS already exists.

Configure your computer to boot from the CD drive. To do this, enter the CMOS setup which is usually done by pressing Del key during booting. Go to the Advanced BIOS Settings and here you will be able to change the boot sequence of your computer. Boot from your Windows XP CD. When you are presented with a choice of installing or repairing an existing installation, choose repair. You'll be asked which XP installation you want to log into. Enter '1'. There is usually only one installation. You'll be prompted for the Administrator password. For XP Home, the default password is blank, so just hit [Enter]. For XP Professional, enter the same password you did during setup for the Administrator account. At the C:\Windows prompt, type 'FIXBOOT'. You'll be prompted to confirm.

When FIXBOOT is finished, remove the XP CD and type EXIT and the machine will reboot. Reconfigure your computer to boot from the hard drive if necessary. Now you will get the XP boot loader with your choice of operating systems.

700 MB via FTP, I encountered the error due to insufficient disk space and I lost those 700 MB permanently and could not recover it.

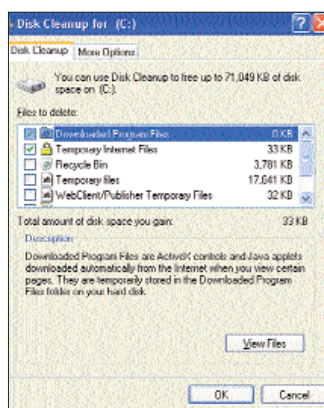
Another strange thing I have observed is that my 'Temporary Internet Files' folder is unusually large in size (961MB) and keeps increasing. Windows says that it contains 14 folders but I can't see even a single folder in it. Since this is a special OS folder, I can't even delete it and recreate it. Please help me recover my HDD space!

Nikhil Wason
New Delhi

A Windows creates a lot of temporary files during the course of its operations.

The sad thing is that it forgets to delete each and every one of these temporary files and hence these files go on accumulating and eating up your hard disk space.

Most of these files can be done away with, though, using the provided 'Disk Cleanup' utility. But even this utility cannot



The Disk Cleanup utility in XP



delete all the unwanted files from the hard drive and you have to live with these files, since some of these are required for the functioning of Windows.

Alternatively, you may use third-party utilities such as Cleanup! from <http://cleanup.stevengould.org> and System Cleaner from www.system-cleaner.com to cleanup your system and registry and free up some more space. Since these third party utilities deal with the registry and system files, use them with a little caution. You may not be able to view the folders inside your 'Windows' folders because these are system folders and your Explorer might not be configured to view hidden and system files and folders.

The other solution would be to do a clean install of Windows XP on your hard drive.

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details to sos@jasubhai.com, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Return To The Game

Q I want to know how I can back up my saved games in *Grand Theft Auto Vice City*, so I can use them after I have reinstalled Windows.

Aamir Khan
Via E-mail

A All GTA Vice City saved games and profiles are placed under "GTA Vice City User Files" in "My Documents". Just copy these to a folder of your choice. When you reinstall Windows and GTA Vice City, just copy these to the original location and you can access your saved games. ■